Codesphere 3.0

BUILD4BETTER

Participant Rulebook

Organised by the Department of Software Engineering, NED University of Engineering and Technology.

This rulebook explains the challenge, participation requirements, original-work policy, submission process and judging criteria. All participating teams must follow these requirements.

1 Event essentials

· Format: Online through Hackathon Hub.

· Date: Saturday, 31 October 2026.

· Build window: 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM Pakistan Standard Time (PKT, UTC+5). Total duration: 8 hours.

· Team size: 2 to 4 students.

· Final submissions: Hackathon Hub only, by 5:00 PM PKT on 31 October 2026.

2 The problem

Most of us in CS and software engineering grew up with technology, so using it feels automatic. Our parents did not. They get stuck on things we find trivial: a banking app that logs them out, a video call that will not connect, a government portal with a confusing form, or a scam message that looks real. When they get stuck, they call us. Many also quietly avoid tools that would make their lives easier because they are afraid of breaking something or looking foolish.

The issue is usually not intelligence. Technology is built for people who already speak its language, and a lot of people never got the chance to learn it.

3 The challenge

Build a tool, app, or dashboard that makes technology easier and less intimidating for people who did not grow up with it, such as parents, grandparents, or anyone else in that position. It should bring them closer to technology instead of just doing things for them.

Show how your solution helps a specific user understand, practise or confidently complete an everyday digital task. Choose a focused, achievable scope for the seven-hour build window.

4 Registration and participation

· Every student must register on Hackathon Hub. Teams must ensure their participation in Build4Better is recorded there, as final submissions will be accepted only through Hackathon Hub.

· Teams must have 2 to 4 students. Keep the team name and member details consistent across registration, the repository and the final submission.

· Teams are responsible for their devices, development tools and internet connection, and for checking official event announcements.

5 Original work and repository history

· Submit your own original project, developed during the official build window.

· Create a new GitHub repository at the start of the build window and commit your progress regularly throughout the event. Do not upload a completed project as a single final commit.

· Repository creation details, commit timestamps and development history will be tracked strictly.

· Standard libraries, frameworks, SDKs, packages and external APIs may be used as dependencies. Credit third-party resources in the README. These must support your own implementation rather than replace it with an existing complete project.

· Stop development at 5:00 PM PKT. Identify the final submitted commit in your README and do not change the submitted version after the deadline unless explicitly instructed by the organisers.

6 Use of AI

AI tools are allowed for ideation, coding, debugging, design and documentation. Teams remain responsible for the correctness, originality and safety of everything submitted.

· Briefly disclose the AI tools used and their role in the README.

· Team members must understand the submitted implementation and be able to demonstrate and explain it.

· AI use alone does not attract a scoring penalty. Design quality and originality are assessed using the published rubric and its scoring caps.

. Demo video matters, make sure to explain the project properly and clearly

7 Final submission requirements

Submit one complete team entry through Hackathon Hub before 5:00 PM PKT on 31 October 2026. A link shared elsewhere does not count as a final submission.

Mandatory GitHub repository link

Provide a working GitHub link with the project source code and a proper README. Ensure judges can access the repository and review its commit history.

The README must include the project title and team members; target user and problem; solution and core features; setup and run instructions; technology stack and dependencies; AI tools and third-party credits; known limitations or mocked features; and the final submitted commit identifier.

Mandatory demo video

Provide an accessible demo video link. The video must not exceed 2 minutes. Briefly introduce the target user and problem, show the core working flow, and explain how the user gains understanding or confidence. Clearly distinguish working features from simulations.

Optional deployed live link

A deployed live link is optional. If provided, keep it accessible for judging and include any necessary test-account instructions without exposing personal credentials.

8 Live judging and submission checks

· The demo video is required even though judging will also be live. Be available at your assigned time and ready to demonstrate the submitted version, answer questions and explain implementation decisions.

· Before the deadline, check that the GitHub repository and video links open correctly and that the README is complete.

· Report a submission or connectivity issue to the organisers immediately, with a timestamped screenshot where possible. Do not assume an extension; any exception must be explicitly announced by the organisers.

10 Fair participation

Plagiarism, falsified development history, fabricated evidence, harassment or interference with other teams may result in disqualification after organiser review. Judges assess the submitted work against the rubric; organisers resolve eligibility and rule-compliance issues. Raise any factual or procedural concern promptly through the official event communication channel.

Teams retain ownership of their original work and must respect the licences of resources they use. Any further permission to publish or reuse team materials should be obtained separately.

11 Closing ceremony and prizes

Prize money will be revealed at the closing ceremony on 12 November 2026 at the Main Auditorium (Mehmood Alam), NED University of Engineering and Technology. Ceremony timings and further arrangements will be announced by the organisers.